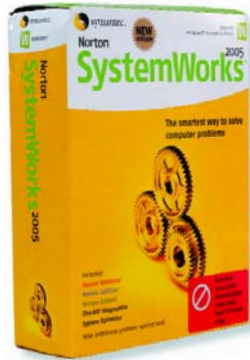


Norton SystemWorks 2005

Works As Usual

SystemWorks 2005, the latest release of the PC maintenance suite from Norton, has Worm Protection and a search bar for Norton GoBack v4.0.

The AntiVirus warned us as we accessed a file infected with W32.Sasser.Worm, but it could not clean it. Out of the box, it lacks the latest signatures of viruses, etc. The virus database in our case was almost three months old.



GoBack v4.0 did retrieve files and folders permanently deleted from a drive. We also tried 'Wipe Info' to delete a Word document, but GoBack retrieved the deleted file. You cannot format a GoBack-protected drive. This is good security, but you cannot opt out of this feature; you can do that only once during installation.

SystemWorks also includes Checkit Diagnostics, which has hardware tests for memory, graphics card, etc. These are mediocre and only provide functionality information. The new System Optimizer utility lets you tweak Windows XP settings.

This is a useful suite if you plan to use GoBack and Checkit, or keep your hard drive free of cluttered data. Updating from an earlier version is however, not recommended.

Company **Tech Pacific India Ltd**
Price **Rs 3,618**
Phone **022-55960238**
Web site **www.symantec.com**

Rating

PalmOne Treo 600

A superlative phone

The candy-bar form factor of the Treo 600 is surprisingly easy to hold, given that it houses an 11-bit, 2.2-inch LCD screen and a QWERTY thumbboard. The screen is 160 x 160, and not as sharp or clear as those of Palm PDAs. The processor is not as fast, and the memory not nearly sufficient for high-end PDA applications. This boils down to the fact that the Treo 600 is not a PDA. It is an excellent phone, however. The thumbboard is surprisingly easy to use and extremely handy. The QWERTY pad is heavenly to jot down notes or send off e-mails on the go.

A comprehensive program to manage contacts also lets you e-mail and SMS. An extremely useful task-management tool ties up with Microsoft Outlook. You can truly have all your data at your fingertips.

For a cell phone, one-handed operation is vital and the Treo 600 delivers, surpassing any PDA, cell phone or Pocket PC phone we have tested.

The battery lasts for around 4 to 5 days with moderate usage. The camera takes pictures that are good enough for MMSes and e-mails.

The Treo 600 is an excellent phone, right from voice quality to usability. Yes, we highly recommend it.



Company **Esource Global**
Price **Rs 37,000** Phone **91-22-26732929 55021620**
E-mail **Sales@esourceglobal.com** Web site **www.esourceglobal.com**

Rating

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1 Poor: Has serious drawbacks and needs improvement before it can be used for its target application. **2 Mediocre:** Does not live up to expectations, needs improvement in many areas. **3 Average:** Reasonably competent but nothing spectacular about the product. **4 Good:** A good buy, better than most products in its category. **5 Excellent:** A brilliant combination of price, performance and features - far beyond expectations.

Optical Desktop with Fingerprint reader

This Microsoft offering comprises a fingerprint-recognition keyboard and an ambidextrous mouse.

The keyboard has a cluttered layout of buttons and a fingerprint scanner. The scanning software integrates well with Windows XP and you can use your finger to log into Windows, or say, your Web mail site. The scanner is convenient and more secure than standard password-protection. Also, programmable buttons allow for one-touch launching of programs.

The wireless mouse is quite similar to the older generation except for an ambidextrous design and a smaller size. Horizontal scrolling offered is a boon for MS Excel users. It requires two AA batteries to work at full-strength but you can also use only one battery to reduce its running cost.



Company **Microsoft Corporation India Pvt Ltd**
Price **Rs 6,776**
Phone **011-26294600**
E-mail **connect@microsoft.com**
Web site **www.microsoft.com**

Rating

Travel PAC World Travel Adapter

World Travel Adapter is a combination of various power plugs, and acts much like a universal plug. It has an innovative Swiss-knife like design with a compact shape and retractable switches that hide inside the adaptor. A handy utility for the frequent traveller, it conforms to various standard sockets with two poles for Australia, Europe, UK, and USA. An in-built fuse protects your precious equipment from ill-mannered power sources. It also comes with a lifetime warranty. However, all this comes at a price (Rs 1,150). Another model from the same company, the World-Connect Adapter is cheaper, with a simpler design and offers surge-protection.



Company **Camac Holdings**
Price **Rs 1,150**
Phone **033-22207961**
E-mail **camac11@vsnl.net**
Web site **www.travelpac.com.sg**

Rating